

The Verve Pipe

Venue: Fountain Square (FSQ) | Console: DiGiCo Q225 | Date: 2026-05-29 | Engineer: Brian Lloyd

Show Overview

The Verve Pipe — original 90s alt-rock band at Fifth Third Center Stage, Fountain Square, Cincinnati OH. Dense guitar-forward mix: two guitar positions each running dual-mic rigs (SM57 + Beta 27), two-mic kick (Beta 91 + Beta 52), and four channels of electronics/loops. Vocals arriving via Dante/wireless — not in this patch. Reverb via Seventh Heaven Pro (6 presets below).

PA: L-Acoustics A15 (4× per side, flown) + 8× KS21 subs (delayed arch). System tuned — do not adjust processor settings.
Monitors: Midas M32 (dedicated — does not rotate to FOH at FSQ).
RF: Tempest unit #215217. Dante/wireless vocals on separate route — confirm feed is live before show.
Outdoor note: No natural room — reverb does all the work. Pre-delay is critical for intelligibility. Don't pull decay down as aggressively as Memo.

Input List — Active Channels

Ch	Instrument	Console Name	Mic / DI	Notes
1	Kick In	Kick In	Shure Beta 91	Attack layer — boundary inside batter head
2	Kick Out	Kick Out	Shure Beta 52	Body/thump layer
3	Snare Top	Snare Top	Shure SM57	
4	Snare Bottom	Snare Bot	Shure SM57	Polarity check vs Ch 3
5	Hat	Hat	Shure SM81	
6	Rack 1	Rack 1	Audix D2	
7	Floor	Floor	Audix D4	
8	Ride	Ride	Shure SM81	
9	Overhead Left	OH Left	Shure SM81	Polarity check — mono sum
10	Overhead Right	OH Right	Shure SM81	Polarity check vs Ch 9
11	Bass DI	Bass DI	Radial ProDI (passive)	Low-end owner in bass blend
12	Bass Mic	Bass Mic	Shure SM57	Polarity check vs Ch 11
13	Guitar Center (SM57)	GTR C 57	Shure SM57	Lead mic in center cab blend
14	Guitar Center (Beta27)	GTR C B27	Shure Beta 27	Polarity check vs Ch 13 — CRITICAL
15		GTR R 57	Shure SM57	Lead mic in right cab blend

	Guitar Right (SM57)			
16	Guitar Right (Beta27)	GTR R B27	Shure Beta 27	Polarity check vs Ch 15 — CRITICAL
17	Acoustic	Acoustic	Radial ProDI (passive)	Onboard pickup assumed
18	Keys	Keys	Radial ProDI (passive)	
19	SPDX	SPDX	Radial ProDI (passive)	Roland SPD-SX — get all pads at soundcheck
20	Looper	Looper	Radial ProDI (passive)	Monitor level as loops stack
21–32	No mic — vocals via Dante/wireless on separate route.			

EQ Summary

Ch	Name	HPF / LPF	Key EQ Moves
1	Kick In	40 Hz / Off	HS -3 @ 8k · Bell -3 @ 3.5k · Bell -4 @ 300 Hz · B4 flat
2	Kick Out	25 Hz / Off	HS -4 @ 8k · Bell -4 @ 2.5k · Bell -3 @ 350 Hz · LS +3 @ 60 Hz
3	Snare Top	100 Hz / Off	HS +2 @ 10k · Bell -2 @ 1.2k · Bell -4 @ 400 Hz · Bell -6 @ 200 Hz
4	Snare Bot	200 Hz / Off	HS +3 @ 8k · Bell -3 @ 2k · Bell -5 @ 400 Hz · LS -8 @ 200 Hz
5	Hat	450 Hz / Off	HS -2 @ 12k · Bell -3 @ 6k · Bell -3 @ 800 Hz · Bell -5 @ 350 Hz
6	Rack 1	80 Hz / Off	HS -2 @ 10k · Bell -3 @ 2k · Bell -4 @ 500 Hz · LS +2 @ 80 Hz
7	Floor	50 Hz / Off	HS -2 @ 8k · Bell -3 @ 2k · Bell -4 @ 400 Hz · LS +3 @ 80 Hz
8	Ride	500 Hz / Off	HS -3 @ 12k · Bell -2 @ 4k · Bell -4 @ 800 Hz · Bell -5 @ 400 Hz
9	OH Left	200 Hz / Off	HS -1 @ 12k · Bell -2 @ 5k · Bell -3 @ 250 Hz · Bell -4 @ 150 Hz
10	OH Right	200 Hz / Off	Matched to Ch 9
11	Bass DI	35 Hz / Off	HS -3 @ 8k · Bell +2 @ 1.5k · Bell -4 @ 250 Hz · LS +2 @ 80 Hz
12	Bass Mic	60 Hz / Off	HS -4 @ 6k · Bell -2 @ 2.5k · Bell -3 @ 400 Hz · Bell -6 @ 100 Hz
13	GTR C 57	100 Hz / Off	HS -2 @ 8k · Bell -3 @ 3k · Bell -4 @ 400 Hz · Bell -6 @ 150 Hz
14	GTR C B27	120 Hz / Off	HS -1 @ 10k · Bell -2 @ 2.5k · Bell -3 @ 350 Hz · LS -4 @ 150 Hz
15	GTR R 57	100 Hz / Off	Matched to Ch 13
16	GTR R B27	120 Hz / Off	Matched to Ch 14
17	Acoustic	80 Hz / Off	

			HS -2 @ 10k · Bell -3 @ 3k · Bell -4 @ 400 Hz · LS -3 @ 120 Hz
18	Keys	40 Hz / Off	HS -2 @ 12k · Bell -3 @ 3k · Bell -3 @ 250 Hz · LS -3 @ 100 Hz
19	SPDX	35 Hz / Off	HS -3 @ 10k · Bell -3 @ 3k · Bell -3 @ 300 Hz · B4 flat
20	Looper	60 Hz / Off	HS -2 @ 10k · Bell -3 @ 3k · Bell -3 @ 400 Hz · Bell -4 @ 150 Hz

Reverb — Seventh Heaven Pro (6 Presets)

FSQ is outdoor — no natural room decay. Keep decay at or near factory; the reverb carries all the space. Pre-delay is critical for intelligibility. Early/Late and Late Rolloff at factory unless noted.

① Vocal Hall | Halls 1 / Concert Hall ✓ verified

Preset: Halls 1 / Concert Hall | Decay 2.2s • PreDelay 18ms • VLF -10dB • Early/Late: factory • Late Rolloff: factory • Mix 12%

2.2s factory decay is appropriate for outdoor — the room isn't adding anything here. Primary vocal hall send. VLF at -10dB factory is already conservative; leave it unless the low end gets muddy outdoors.

② Vocal Plate | Plates 1 / Vocal Plate ✓ verified (#06)

Preset: Plates 1 / Vocal Plate | Decay 1.5s • PreDelay 24ms • VLF -19dB • Equal Mix • Late Rolloff: factory • Mix 15%

Factory settings throughout. VLF at -19dB keeps the low end clean. Good workhorse when the hall gets too big outdoors, or as the primary on backgrounds. Pulls back behind the voice without washing it.

③ Vocal — Something Nice | Chambers 1 / Sunset Chamber ✓ verified

Preset: Chambers 1 / Sunset Chamber | Decay 2.15s • PreDelay 20ms • VLF -20dB • Early/Late: factory • Late Rolloff: factory • Mix 10%

Long, warm chamber. At Memo you'd pull decay back — at FSQ let it run at factory 2.15s; the room adds nothing underneath it. The Verve Pipe's catalog suits this quality. Keep mix conservative; it's an enveloping send, not a slapback.

④ Guitar Room | Rooms 2 / Guitar Room ✓ verified (#16)

Preset: Rooms 2 / Guitar Room | Decay 1.2s • PreDelay 0ms • VLF -11dB • Equal Mix • Late Rolloff: factory • Mix 8%

300ms hardware delay baked in at -14dB — leave it. That's the point of this preset. Feed the SM57 channels (Ch 13, 15); Beta27 blend at lower send level. Mix low; the delay provides depth without wash.

⑤ Snare | Plates 1 / Snare Plate A ✓ verified

Preset: Plates 1 / Snare Plate A | Decay 1.2s • PreDelay: factory • VLF -9dB • Early/Late: factory • Late Rolloff: factory • Mix 20%

Run it hotter than you would at Memo — outdoors the snare crack has nothing to bounce off. Dense and fast. Watch feedback with open mics; outdoor gain margins are tighter.

⑥ Acoustic / Keys | Rooms 1 / Large Wooden ✓ verified

Preset: Rooms 1 / Large Wooden | Decay 1.2s • PreDelay: factory • VLF -9dB • Early/Late: factory • Late Rolloff: factory • Mix 10%

Shared send for acoustic (Ch 17) and keys (Ch 18). Natural, airy room — seats those cleaner DI sources in the same space without over-processing. Good foil to the denser vocal sends.

Mic Choices & Notes

Kick — Two-Mic Rig

Beta 91 (Ch 1) inside on batter head — attack/click. Beta 52 (Ch 2) for body. Start Ch 1 at unity, bring Ch 2 up for weight. +3 dB low shelf at 60 Hz on Ch 2 feeds the KS21 subs.

Snare

SM57 top and bottom. Polarity check on Ch 4 vs Ch 3 before advancing fader — almost always needs flipping.

Hat / Ride

SM81 on both. Aggressive HPF (450 / 500 Hz). Duckers rather than hard gates on both.

Overheads

SM81 pair, true overhead position. Stereo linked. Check mono sum before advancing.

Bass

Radial ProDI (Ch 11) for fundamental; SM57 on cab (Ch 12) for grit. Polarity check Ch 12 vs Ch 11. DI owns the bottom.

Guitars — Dual-Mic Rigs

Each cab: SM57 (attack, lead) + Beta 27 (warmth, blend). Center = Ch 13/14, Right = Ch 15/16. Start SM57 at unity, Beta 27 6–8 dB below. Polarity check each Beta 27 before blending. Check mono sum for comb filtering around 300–500 Hz.

Acoustic / Keys / Electronics

All passive Radial ProDI. Acoustic EQ assumes onboard piezo — adjust at soundcheck. SPDY: Band 4 flat until you hear the patches. Looper: monitor level as layers build; comp threshold may need live adjustment.

Patching & Routing

Group	Channels	VCA	Reverb Sends
Drums	1–10	Drums	Snare → ⑤ Snare Plate · OH → ④ Guitar Room (light)
Bass	11–12	Bass	—
Guitars	13–16	Guitars	Ch 13/15 SM57 → ④ Guitar Room

Keys/ Electronics	17–20	Keys/ Elec	Acoustic/Keys → ⑥ Large Wooden
Vocals	21–32	Vocals	Lead → ①②③ to taste · Bgvox → ① Hall

Soundcheck Order

- 1. Confirm Dante/wireless vocal feed routing to Q225 Ch 21–32
- 2. Kick Ch 1 solo → blend Ch 2
- 3. Bass DI Ch 11 → blend Ch 12 (polarity check)
- 4. Full drum kit — gates/duckers, snare polarity
- 5. GTR C 57 (Ch 13) → blend B27 (Ch 14, polarity check)
- 6. GTR R 57 (Ch 15) → blend B27 (Ch 16, polarity check)
- 7. Acoustic Ch 17 — tune EQ to actual pickup
- 8. Keys Ch 18 · SPDx all pads Ch 19 · Looper Ch 20
- 9. Set reverb levels against vocal feed
- 10. Band pass

File Index

File	Description
The Verve Pipe - FOH Channel Processing.pdf	Full per-channel EQ/dynamics cards with Quick Summaries
The Verve Pipe - FOH Channel Processing.html	HTML source
The Verve Pipe - FOH Channel Processing.md	Machine-readable patcher source
The Verve Pipe - Show Packet.pdf	This document
apply_vervepipe.py	Q225 patcher script (Stage 2 pending — strip structure investigation in progress)